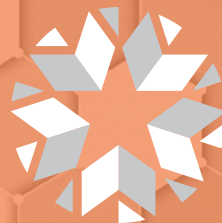


OKLAHOMA SCHOOL TESTING PROGRAM

TEST BLUEPRINT AND ITEM SPECIFICATIONS

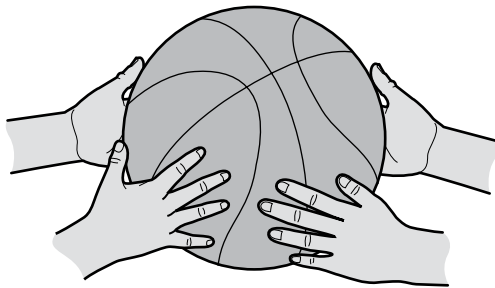
GRADE 8 ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS



OKLAHOMA
Education

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Lifelong Friends



- 1 Megan's family moved in down the street the summer of our third-grade year. I can still remember the feeling of excitement when Mr. Jackson, our next-door neighbor, mentioned to my dad that the new family had a girl my age. I was thrilled. I was looking forward to having a best friend!
- 2 We became inseparable almost immediately, spending every waking moment together. All of my expectations for the potential friendship turned out just as I had anticipated. The first day of school that August was a bit of a disappointment for us when we were not in the same class, but we both eventually came to the realization that it was actually in our best interest, for we would most certainly have too much fun if we were in the same class together. It is unbelievable that five years have passed since then.
- 3 Megan has a basketball net on her garage, and throughout the years, we have spent countless hours shooting baskets. We both actually became pretty good, and in sixth grade decided to try out for our school's basketball team. We both made the team and became starters, thriving on the support we gave one another. When one of us had a disappointing game, the other provided an encouraging pep talk.
- 4 We started eighth grade last August, and at the onset of the season, Coach called all of the starters into his office to discuss the added pressure that would be thrust upon us this year. With high school quickly approaching and coaches scrutinizing our every move on the court, there would be a lot of added pressure. He asked Megan and me to wait around after everyone else left. After the locker room had cleared, he told us that a number of high school coaches were talking about the two of us, and how we both seemed to be really strong candidates for the middle school all-city team. We left his office feeling self-assured, reveling at the possibility of both of us being selected for the honor.
- 5 "One thing for sure, though," Megan said in a suddenly sobering tone, "let's not let this opportunity come between us."

- 6 "What do you mean?" I questioned.
- 7 "Well, I know that we're both pretty confident about being selected," Megan said, "but what if one of us makes it, and the other doesn't?"
- 8 "No way," I said. "That's not going to happen," I insisted, squashing the idea before it could grow.
- 9 Well, the season marched on at a swift pace, and we alternated being the standout of each game. But then, things changed. Megan had three outstanding games in a row. Coach called me aside and told me to relax because he thought I was putting too much pressure on myself and was forcing too many of my shots. But the more I tried to relax, the worse I played.
- 10 It was my worst fear, but unexpectedly, things started to change between Megan and me. The friendly competition we once enjoyed transformed into a rivalry. By the end of the season, Megan and I were barely acknowledging each other.
- 11 The announcement of the middle school all-city team came about a week after the conclusion of the season, and as I anticipated, Megan made the team, and I did not. I struggled to utter a sincere "Congratulations."
- 12 The end of the school year brought the beginning of an unsettling summer. Our faltering friendship found me with plenty of time on my hands. By the beginning of July, I had recurring thoughts about how foolish I had been to let pettiness and jealousy seep into our friendship. I struggled with the thought of apologizing to Megan, but pride and embarrassment hindered me from doing the admirable thing.
- 13 Megan must possess psychic powers because, not a week later, the doorbell rang and Mom called out, "It's Megan." I struggled with the thought of facing the inevitable.
- 14 "Hey," Megan struggled to say, but continued, "how's it going?"
- 15 "I'm hanging in there," I replied.
- 16 There was an awkward moment of silence when I finally uttered, "Listen, Megan, I was wrong to let jealousy interfere with our friendship. I know it's a lot to ask for you to accept my apology, but I'm really sorry."
- 17 "No problem," Megan responded. "I was getting pretty conceited with all of the attention I was getting."
- 18 "I sure learned a valuable lesson from all of this," I said. "Nothing is worth jeopardizing a friendship like ours."
- 19 "You're right about that," she said. "Let's go shoot some baskets."

"Lifelong Friends." Copyright © 2022 Cognia, Inc.

1 Which sentence is the best summary of paragraphs 3 and 4?

- A** Megan and the narrator are warned by the coach about pressures that may be directed toward them as starters on their school team.
- B** Megan and the narrator are confident in their individual basketball abilities and provide support to each other as they play on school teams.
- C** Because Megan and the narrator have skills in basketball and spend a great deal of time practicing and supporting each other, they have been encouraged by their coach to try out for a special city team.
- D** Since they first began playing basketball in sixth grade, Megan and the narrator have been starters on their school teams, and they continue to demonstrate their talents as members of the eighth-grade team.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

8.2.R.1: Students will summarize alphabetic and/or multimodal texts about similar topics to demonstrate comprehension within and between texts.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must have a strong understanding of paragraphs 3 and 4. Then the student must identify the key points in these paragraphs to develop a summary.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is a detail presented only in paragraph 4.
- B. This is a detail presented in both paragraphs, but the information about the all-city team is important to include in the summary.
- C. Correct. This sentence provides a summary of details for both paragraphs 3 and 4.**
- D. This does include details from both paragraphs but does not provide a summary of the paragraphs.

2 How can the reader tell that the selection is fiction?

- A** It describes different times and places.
- B** It features a plot and fictional characters.
- C** It includes relatable thoughts and feelings.
- D** It has an interesting and original main idea.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

8.2.R.2: Students will analyze details in fiction, poetry, and nonfiction texts to identify characteristics of genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the item requires that the student know the features of fiction and apply that knowledge to make a determination about the passage.

Distractor Rationale

- A. A nonfiction/informational selection could also include different times and places.
- B. Correct. Plots and characters are important components of fictional selections like short stories.**
- C. A nonfiction/informational selection could also include thoughts and feelings.
- D. A nonfiction/informational selection could also include an interesting and original main idea.

3 Read the sentence.

The friendly competition we once enjoyed transformed into a rivalry.

This sentence contributes to the meaning of the passage by

- A** identifying the conflict.
- B** introducing the theme.
- C** describing the characters.
- D** developing the point of view.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

8.3.R.3: Students will analyze literary elements to support interpretations of a literary text:

- setting
- plot
- characters (i.e., protagonist, antagonist)
- characterization
- conflict (i.e., internal, external)
- point of view (i.e., third person limited and omniscient and second person)

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because it requires the student to analyze a portion of the text and make an inference as to how it contributes to the passage as a whole.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** This sentence introduces the conflict that the narrator and Megan experience.
- B.** The theme of the passage is stated in paragraph 18. This sentence does not support the theme of the passage.
- C.** This sentence is not describing Megan or the narrator but the conflict they are experiencing.
- D.** This sentence is not stating or developing a point of view.

4 Read the sentence from the passage.

We became inseparable almost immediately, spending every waking moment together.

What does the hyperbole suggest about the girls' relationship?

- A** The girls had no other friends.
- B** The girls played no other sports.
- C** The girls had the same teachers.
- D** The girls spent a great deal of time together.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

8.3.R.4: Students will analyze literary devices to support an interpretation of a text:

- figurative language (i.e., simile, metaphor, personification, hyperbole, imagery, symbolism, idiom)
- sound devices (i.e., onomatopoeia, alliteration)
- verbal and situational irony

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student applies knowledge about hyperbole to determine what it tells about a particular relationship.

Distractor Rationale

- A. That is not what is suggested by the hyperbole.
- B. That is not what is suggested by the hyperbole.
- C. That is not what is suggested by the hyperbole.
- D. Correct.** The hyperbole “spending every waking moment together” suggests that the girls were never out of each other’s sight, which would be impossible since they did not even live in the same house.

5 In paragraph 4, the word scrutinizing means

- A** unfairly judging.
- B** closely watching.
- C** loudly criticizing.
- D** passionately cheering.

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

8.4.R.2: Students will use context clues, connotation, and denotation to determine or clarify the meaning of words or distinguish among multiple-meaning words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must draw meaning from the text to determine the meaning of an unfamiliar word.

Distractor Rationale

- A. As used in paragraph 4, the high school coaches are looking closely at every move the players make on the court, not unfairly judging them.
- B. Correct. The coaches are looking closely at every move the players make on the court as a consideration for future placement on a high school team.**
- C. As used in paragraph 4, the high school coaches are looking closely at every move the players make on the court, not loudly criticizing them.
- D. As used in paragraph 4, the high school coaches are looking closely at every move the players make on the court, not passionately cheering them.

6 Which research question would best help a student find information about the importance of friendly competition?

- A** Which sports activities are the most competitive?
- B** Is competition important for people to be successful?
- C** What are some strategies that promote healthy competition?
- D** Which professional athlete has the best reputation for being a positive competitor?

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

8.6.R.1: Students will find and comprehend information (e.g., claims, evidence) about a topic, using their own viable research questions.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must comprehend the passage and apply the skill of developing research questions to respond to the question.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Knowing what sports are the most competitive would not provide the best information about the importance of friendly competition.
- B. Knowing if competition is important for people to be successful would not provide the best information about the importance of friendly competition.
- C. Correct. Knowing how to promote healthy competition would provide the best information about the importance of friendly competition.**
- D. Knowing which professional athlete is known for having a good reputation as a positive competitor would not provide the best information about the importance of friendly competition.

You will now read two related passages and answer the questions that follow. Some of these questions may ask you to compare the two passages.

Oklahoma's Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge

- 1 When people think about Oklahoma, they may imagine a vast plain filled with prairies, farms, and ranches. But millions of years ago, parts of Oklahoma were covered by an ancient sea named the Western Interior Seaway. Today, we see evidence of that ancient sea in the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge (SPNWR).
- 2 This magical place is known for more than its unusual landscape. Endangered and threatened wildlife can be seen here. Rock hounds¹ seeking hourglass selenite crystals, Oklahoma's state crystal, can only dig for them at the salt flats.

Salt Flats

- 3 Due to shifts in the Earth's crust, the Western Interior Seaway became cut off from its water source and evaporated, leaving a thick crust of salt coating parts of the land. Even though the sea is gone, shallow pools and streams remain. The ground here is unable to absorb a lot of water, so rain frequently adds to shallow pools and streams. Rivers in this region contribute to some of the bodies of water in the refuge, and salty groundwater continues to flow just beneath the earth's surface. So, when the ground becomes saturated, the salty water seeps up from below the surface, adding to the pools and streams. As the water evaporates, the salt is left behind, adding to the unique landscape.



The Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge is a very unique ecosystem.

Going to the Birds

- 4 At first glance, it may not seem like many animals could survive in the SPNWR. However, there is an abundance of wildlife here. The refuge contains grasslands and wooded areas, which are home to animals like white-tailed deer, squirrels, American badgers, and many others. In addition, the SPNWR is an important stop for migrating birds.

¹**rock hound:** a person who has a special interest in and collects rocks and minerals

- 5 Over 300 different types of birds can be found at the SPNWR. During the spring and fall, the bird population is at its highest as birds travel from one region to another. Like the birds, birdwatchers flock to the Great Salt Plains Lake, which is located primarily in the SPNWR. The lake is not very deep; in fact, the deepest part of the lake measures less than 8 feet.
- 6 The shallow waters are great for feeding hungry birds. Invertebrates, such as worms, snails, and insects, are important food sources for nesting snowy plovers and other shorebirds. The least terns, a type of bird, feed along the rivers that flow through the salt flats. A popular food for many birds is the salt brine fly, which hatches when water is available.

A Special Crystal

- 7 The SPNWR is the only place to find hourglass selenite crystals. In fact, one of the main reasons people visit this refuge is to dig for these unusual crystals.
- 8 Beth Ullenberg of the U.S. Fish & Wildlife Service explains the process: The crystals form when gypsum (a mineral) in the soil mixes with salty groundwater. As they grow, the crystals trap sand and clay and sometimes sticks, rocks, and bones. These materials help create the hourglass-shaped inclusions inside the crystal as it grows outward from the center.
- 9 This hourglass shape is not found in selenite crystals anywhere else in the world—it is only found on the salt plains of northwest Oklahoma. Because it is so unique, the hourglass-shaped selenite crystal was designated as the state crystal of Oklahoma in 2005.



Hourglass selenite crystals were designated the Oklahoma state crystal in 2005. The crystals themselves are a form of gypsum. Iron oxide in the soil gives the hourglass inside the crystals its chocolatey brown color.

- 10 Visitors may only dig for these rare crystals from April 1 through October 15 because the area is a critical habitat for whooping cranes. It is also a nesting place for many birds. In fact, birds will often look for food in the holes left by those digging for crystals. The U.S. Fish & Wildlife Service offers these tips for crystal digging:

Digging for Crystals at Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge

1. Use a shovel to dig a hole about two feet deep and two feet across until you reach wet sand. You may feel the shovel break through the crystals as it goes down. This cannot be helped as there is no way of predicting exactly where a bed of crystals is located.
2. Allow two or three inches of water to seep in from the bottom.
3. Use your hand or a container to splash water gently against the sides of the hole. The agitated water will wash the soil away from the crystals.
4. When you find a crystal formation, continue splashing to wash it free of the supporting sand and clay.
5. At this stage of the process, the newly exposed crystals are wet and fragile so use great care removing them.
6. After removing crystals from sand, place them where the sun and wind will dry them. Egg cartons or other containers are recommended for transporting the crystals.

- 11 Regardless of what draws visitors to this refuge, they are sure to be impressed. The remnants of that ancient sea have left behind an ecosystem that is essential to several endangered and threatened birds as well as other animals. It has also left behind a unique geology that fascinates those who spend time there.

"Oklahoma's Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge." Copyright© 2022 Cognia, Inc.

Read this passage, which goes with the previous passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

“A Special Place”: Birds and Crystals Make the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge Unique

by Ed Godfrey

- 1 In April, the spring migration of birds slows down at the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge, and the crystal digging begins.
- 2 Birdwatching and crystal digging are the two most popular pastimes at Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge, one of the most distinctive areas in the world. It is recognized internationally by the Western Hemisphere Shorebird Reserve Network for providing critically important shorebird habitat. Only about a dozen other wildlife refuges have that honor.
- 3 During the summer, the refuge is typically home for egrets, herons, American avocets, and other shorebirds. A few resident pelicans stick around for the summer but most fly north, says Colby Wyatt. Wyatt is an administrative officer at the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge. If visitors at the refuge are not there with their binoculars to watch birds during the summer, then they are most likely there with a shovel and a bucket to dig for crystals.
- 4 Selenite crystal digging on the salt flats opens April 1 and runs through October 15. On October 16, the digging areas close for the birds to use in the fall and winter. The entire refuge is designated as a critical whooping crane habitat.



Digging for hourglass crystals requires simple tools: a bucket and a shovel. It can get pretty hot, so bringing water and an umbrella or tent for shade is a good idea.

- 5 Crystal digging was never more popular than in 2020 when more than 130,000 people visited the refuge to hunt for the stones in the sand. "There were record weekends," Wyatt said. "There were several weekends it hit way over a couple of thousand. We had license plates from New Jersey, New York, Washington, Florida. It was all over. Typically, especially in the summertime, we do get more of an international presence," he said. "A lot of people from Japan and Germany, and the Norwegian states, like to come through here."
- 6 The Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge is the only known site in the world where selenite crystals with brown hourglass inclusions are found. This makes them a collector's item for rock hound¹ enthusiasts. Because the crystals form in wet soil, sand, and clay, particles are included within the crystal giving them their unique "hourglass" shape inside. "That (hourglass shape) is very unique throughout the world, so we have a lot of collectors that come in that want to get a crystal from here," Wyatt said.
- 7 The Salt Plains is one of the few places within the national wildlife refuge system where something is allowed to be removed. Collectors can keep up to 10 pounds of crystals per day. Wyatt said it is rare anyone leaves with that much, although almost all diggers leave with at least some amounts of the crystallized form of gypsum.
- 8 It takes seven years for the crystals to form, so the refuge has eight separate digging areas that are rotated annually for the public to use. "By the time it's time to dig again (in an area), the crystals have formed," Wyatt said.
- 9 The crystal digging also benefits some of the shorebirds that nest in the area. Mounds left from dig seasons are used by birds as elevated nesting platforms. The mounds give the shorebirds a place to nest above the floodplain during the rainy seasons and increase their nest success.
- 10 "We found that (crystal digging) was an activity that benefited the refuge," Wyatt said.

¹**rock hound:** a person who has a special interest in and collects rocks and minerals

"'A Special Place': Birds and Crystals Make the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge Unique" by Ed Godfrey, from *The Oklahoman*, April 24, 2021. Copyright © 2021 by The Oklahoman. Republished by permission.

7 Which feature from the passage “A Special Place” shows that the genre is nonfiction?

- A** an expert providing factual information
- B** quotation marks to indicate spoken words
- C** descriptive language to communicate ideas
- D** an opening paragraph establishing the setting

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

8.2.R.2: Students will analyze details in fiction, poetry, and nonfiction texts to identify characteristics of genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to know the features of different genres and apply that knowledge to the passage to determine how it should be classified.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** The author quotes an expert who is an employee of the refuge and provides factual information; this shows that the genre of the passage is nonfiction.
- B.** The use of quotation marks is not limited to nonfiction.
- C.** Other genres use descriptive language so its use in the passage does not show that the genre is nonfiction.
- D.** This technique is used by other genres and does not show that the genre of this passage is nonfiction.

- 8** After reading both passages, a student has an assignment to write a paper about the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge. They want to narrow the focus of their paper by choosing a more specific topic.

Which pre-writing strategy will **best** help the student accomplish their goal?

- A** Create a map of the refuge to include in the paper.
- B** Brainstorm ideas by listing facts about the refuge.
- C** Write a draft of an introduction for the paper.
- D** Find resources about other wildlife refuges.

Standard 2: Students will engage in a recursive process that may include prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing.

8.2.W.1: Students will routinely and recursively prewrite (e.g., develop ideas and plan).

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must recall pre-writing strategies and then apply that knowledge to select the most appropriate method.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Creating a map is not an effective pre-writing strategy for this purpose.
- B. Correct. Listing facts in a brainstorming activity is an effective pre-writing strategy for determining a focus because it will generate ideas for possible topics.**
- C. Writing an introduction is not an effective pre-writing strategy for determining a focus.
- D. Finding resources about other wildlife refuges will likely not help the student narrow the focus of a paper about a specific refuge.

- 9** Which statement describes how **both** passages present information about the wildlife refuge?
- A** "Oklahoma's Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge" is written in a humorous tone, while "A Special Place" is written as a serious analysis of the purpose of the wildlife refuge.
 - B** The author of "Oklahoma's Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge" provides a broad view of the refuge, while the author of "A Special Place" focuses on how the refuge is currently used.
 - C** The author of "Oklahoma's Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge" describes a sequence of events at the refuge, while the author of "A Special Place" uses a compare and contrast structure.
 - D** "Oklahoma's Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge" is written as an argumentative essay about the importance of wildlife refuges, while "A Special Place" is written to inform about a wildlife refuge.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

8.3.R.1: Students will analyze works written on the same topic from a variety of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives and analyze the methods the authors use to achieve their purposes.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because the student must perform a cross-text evaluation to make a decision about how the authors of both texts presented information on the topic.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is not accurate, as the tone of the first passage is not humorous.
- B. Correct. The author of the first passage provides historical context and takes a broad view of the purpose of the refuge, while the author of the second passage limits the focus to the current use.**
- C. The first passage is organized by topic, and the second passage does not use a compare and contrast structure.
- D. The first passage is informative rather than argumentative.

10 In paragraph 11 of “Oklahoma’s Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge,” which 2 phrases best help the reader understand the meaning of the word **remnants**?

- A** ancient sea / left behind
- B** sure to be impressed / that is essential
- C** endangered and threatened birds / unique geology
- D** sure to be impressed / endangered and threatened birds

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

8.4.R.2: Students will use context clues, connotation, and denotation to determine or clarify the meaning of words or distinguish among multiple-meaning words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to determine the meaning of an unfamiliar word using textual clues in a given paragraph.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** “Ancient sea” indicates that something very old is being discussed and “left behind” shows that even though it is not there anymore, evidence of the object remains.
- B.** The word remnant means “a small part or trace remaining,” which is not supported by the phrases “sure to be impressed / that is essential.”
- C.** The word remnant means “a small part or trace remaining,” which is not supported by the phrases “endangered and threatened birds / unique geology.”
- D.** The word remnant means “a small part or trace remaining,” which is not supported by the phrases “sure to be impressed / endangered and threatened birds.”

Reread paragraph 11 from “Oklahoma’s Most Unusual Wildlife Refuge.” Drag two phrases from the paragraph that **best** help the reader understand the meaning of the word **remnants** into the appropriate boxes.

To drag a phrase, click and hold the sentence, and then drag it to the desired space. To change a sentence, click and hold it, and then drag it back to the original location.

sure to be impressed

ancient sea

left behind

endangered and threatened

Phrases

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

8.4.R.2: Students will use context clues, connotation, and denotation to determine or clarify the meaning of words or distinguish among multiple-meaning words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to determine the meaning of an unfamiliar word using textual clues in a given paragraph.

Sample Distractor Rationales:

Correct

Phrases
ancient sea
left behind

Incorrect

Phrases
sure to be impressed
endangered and threatened

12 Read the sentence from the passage “A Special Place.”

It is recognized internationally by the Western **Hemisphere** Shorebird Reserve Network for providing critically important shorebird habitat.

Based on the meaning of the prefix **hemi-** and the word **sphere**, what does the word **hemisphere** mean?

- A** part of a group
- B** related to nature
- C** half of the globe
- D** equal in distance

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

8.4.R.3: Students will use word parts (e.g., affixes, Greek roots, stems) to define and determine the meaning of increasingly complex words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to recall the meaning of an affix and base word and apply that knowledge to determine the meaning of the word created when they are put together.

Distractor Rationale

- A. “Part of a group” is relevant to the context of the sentence, as the network is a group, but it is not the meaning of the word “hemisphere.”
- B. “Related to nature” might be an appealing option, as the group is involved in overseeing shorebird habitats, but the word “hemisphere” means half of a sphere.
- C. **Correct.** The prefix “hemi-” means half, and “sphere” means globe. The group represents the Western Hemisphere.
- D. “Equal in distance” may suggest equal halves (hemi-) but this is not the meaning of the word hemisphere, which means half of the globe.

13 In the following sentence, which word should replace **way** to be more precise?

The U.S. Fish & Wildlife Service offers advice on the best **way** for successfully digging for crystals.

- A** application
- B** procedure
- C** situation
- D** structure

Standard 4: Students will apply knowledge of vocabulary to speak and write effectively.

8.4.W.1: Students will use precise, grade-level vocabulary in writing to clearly communicate ideas.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to identify synonyms for a particular word and determine which of those synonyms is most precise for use in the sentence.

Distractor Rationale

- A. “Application” is not what “way” means in the sentence, as “application” means an action. While the word might fit into the sentence logically, it is not the most precise word to replace “way.” The advice from the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service is a very specific procedure—conducted in a specific order.
- B. Correct. “Procedure” is what the word “way” refers to in the sentence, and more precisely communicates the advice. “Procedure” is an accurate description of the step-by-step instructions for how to dig for crystals.**
- C. “Situation” might appear to fit in the sentence, but it does not accurately capture the intended meaning of “way.” “Situation” means a set of circumstances rather than a specific way of doing something (procedure).
- D. “Structure” is not what “way” means in this sentence, as it suggests a completed organization of parts rather than a procedure for accomplishing a task, or perhaps that there is a type of structure needed for the task. The precise choice is “procedure,” as that is the content of the advice.

A student is writing a paper about the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge as a habitat for whooping cranes. The student wants to organize the notes to indicate primary and secondary sources. Complete the chart by dragging one primary and one secondary source into the appropriate boxes.

To drag a phrase, click and hold the phrase, and then drag it to the desired space. To change a phrase, click and hold it, and then drag it back to the original location.

a website listing locations and times to view whooping cranes

a published journal of a birdwatcher who observes whooping cranes regularly

a narrative essay about watching whooping cranes arrive at the refuge

a documentary about refuges for whooping cranes and other endangered birds

Primary Sources	Secondary Sources
an interview with a scientist who travels to the refuge each year to study whooping cranes	a chapter in a science textbook about the migration patterns of whooping cranes

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

8.6.R.2: Students will find, record, and organize information from a variety of primary and secondary sources, following ethical and legal guidelines.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must recall the features of primary and secondary sources and apply that knowledge to a set of options.

Correct

Primary Sources	Secondary Sources
an interview with a scientist who travels to the refuge each year to study whooping cranes	a chapter in a science textbook about the migration patterns of whooping cranes
a narrative essay about watching whooping cranes arrive at the refuge	a website listing locations and times to view whooping cranes

Incorrect

Primary Sources	Secondary Sources
an interview with a scientist who travels to the refuge each year to study whooping cranes	a chapter in a science textbook about the migration patterns of whooping cranes
a documentary about refuges for whooping cranes and other endangered birds	a published journal of a birdwatcher who observes whooping cranes regularly

Distractor Rationale

The student is unclear about the differences between primary and secondary sources.

- 15** A student is writing a paper about the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge as a habitat for whooping cranes. They need to add notes from a primary source.

Which source is a primary source?

- A** a website listing locations and times to view whooping cranes
- B** a published journal of a birdwatcher who follows whooping cranes
- C** a documentary about refuges for whooping cranes and other endangered birds
- D** a chapter in a science textbook about the migration patterns of whooping cranes

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

8.6.R.2: Students will find, record, and organize information from a variety of primary and secondary sources, following ethical and legal guidelines.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must recall the features of primary and secondary sources and apply that knowledge to a set of options.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The website is a secondary source, as it contains an informational list of locations and times rather than a firsthand account.
- B. Correct. A journal contains a firsthand account in the writer's own words, so it is a primary source.**
- C. A documentary about refuges for whooping cranes and other endangered birds is a secondary source, as it provides information but is not a firsthand account.
- D. A science textbook contains information in the form of expository text and is not an example of a primary source.

- 16** Which sentence is the **best** thesis statement for a report about the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge?
- A** People come from all over the world every year to birdwatch and dig for crystals at the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge.
 - B** People who are interested in seeing the endangered whooping crane will travel to view them in their habitat at the Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge.
 - C** The Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge is unique because of its value as a bird habitat and as a site where a rare type of selenite crystal can be found.
 - D** The Salt Plains National Wildlife Refuge is unusual because it is the only site where rock collectors can find selenite crystals with brown hourglass inclusions.

Standard 6: Students will synthesize information ethically through speaking and writing.

8.6.W.2: Students will develop a clear, concise, defensible thesis statement.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because the student needs to synthesize information from each passage and then decide which choice best states a formal thesis statement that fully encompasses the ideas in the passages.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This statement is more of a general summary and lacks the scope of a thesis statement.
- B. This statement is incomplete, as it only includes one aspect of the topic (whooping cranes).
- C. Correct. This statement is a concise and complete thesis statement about the focus of the topic.**
- D. This statement is incomplete, as it only includes one aspect of the topic (selenite crystals).

A student wrote a report on a historic home. Read the first part of the report, think about what suggestions you would make, and then answer the questions.

The Mount Laurel Home and Estate—Part 1

1 The Mount Laurel Home and Estate was built in 1780 and was the primary
2 residence for the Robert Clayton family for several generations. In 1927, the
3 home and grounds were placed on the historical register and donated to the
4 public.

5 Last year, conservationists restored the home and opened it for tours.

About Robert Clayton

6 Robert Clayton (1742–1793) was an American colonist in Massachusetts.
7 Although he was only marginally involved in early American politics. Robert
8 Clayton was a contemporary of the Founding Fathers. And reportedly once dined
9 with George and Martha Washington. Excused from serving in the Revolutionary
10 War because of health problems, he earned his wealth through trading. He
11 married Mary Culpepper in 1770, and together they raised five sons and three
12 daughters. He died of pneumonia at the age of 51.

"The Mount Laurel Home and Estate—Part 1." Copyright © 2022 Cognia, Inc.

17 What change, if any, should be made to the sentence in line 5 to make it the active voice?

- A** Last year, tours were opened for the home after it was restored by conservationists.
- B** Last year after being restored by conservationists, tours were opened for the home.
- C** Last year, the home was restored by conservationists, and tours were being opened for the home.
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

8.5.R.1: Students will recognize active and passive voice and misplaced and dangling modifiers in sentences

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to apply knowledge about active and passive voice to correct the sentence.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This sentence is passive voice because the home was restored and opened by the conservationists.
- B. This sentence is passive voice because the home was restored and opened by the conservationists.
- C. This sentence is passive voice because the home was restored and opened by the conservationists.
- D. **Correct.** The sentence is in active voice because the conservationists restored and opened the home.

18 What change, if any, should be made to the sentences in lines 7–9?

- A** Although he was only marginally involved in early American politics, and he was a contemporary of the Founding Farmers. And reportedly once dined with George and Martha Washington.
- B** Although only marginally involved in early American politics. Clayton was a contemporary of the Founding Fathers, and he reportedly once dined with George and Martha Washington.
- C** Although only marginally involved in early American politics, Clayton was a contemporary of the Founding Fathers, and he reportedly once dined with George and Martha Washington.
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

8.5.W.1: Students will compose simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences to add clarity and variety in their writing.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to apply knowledge about sentence structure to correct the sentence.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This format incorrectly contains sentence fragments.
- B. This format incorrectly has a sentence fragment.
- C. Correct. This format contains a complete sentence, with no fragments or run-ons.**
- D. This format incorrectly has two sentence fragments.

19 Which type of verbal is used in lines 9 and 10?

- A** gerund
- B** infinitive
- C** participial phrase
- D** prepositional phrase

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

8.5.R.2: Students will recognize and explain the impact on meaning of parts of speech in sentences:

- nouns
- verbals (i.e., gerunds, participles, infinitives)
- cumulative and coordinate adjectives
- vague pronouns
- singular *they/them/their*
- coordinating, subordinating, and correlative conjunctions
- adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student is doing more than recalling what a verbal is. The student must also make a determination as to how the verbal is being used.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The verbal is not a gerund because it is not being used as a noun but as an adjective describing Clayton.
- B. The verbal is not an infinitive because it does not have a verb preceded by “to.”
- C. Correct. This verbal is a participial phrase being used as an adjective to describe Clayton.**
- D. The verbal is not a prepositional phrase because prepositional phrases cannot be verbals.

20 How is the gerund trading being used in line 10?

- A** as a verb
- B** as a noun
- C** as an adverb
- D** as an adjective

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

8.5.R.2: Students will recognize and explain the impact on meaning of parts of speech in sentences:

- nouns
- verbals (i.e., gerunds, participles, infinitives)
- cumulative and coordinate adjectives
- vague pronouns
- singular *they/them/their*
- coordinating, subordinating, and correlative conjunctions
- adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student is doing more than recalling what a gerund is. The student must also make a determination as to how the gerund is being used.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Gerunds can only be used as nouns.
- B. Correct. The word “trading” is a noun being used as the object of the preposition “through.”**
- C. Gerunds can only be used as nouns.
- D. Gerunds can only be used as nouns.

Read the next part of the report, think about what suggestions you would make, and then answer the question.

The Mount Laurel Home and Estate—Part 2

- 13 The Mount Laurel Home and Estate includes five structures: the main house,
14 the kitchen, the icehouse, the barn, and the blacksmith shed. The division of the
15 kitchen from the main house was common at the time because of the risk of fire.
16 The grounds of the estate cover approximately 250 acres. The gardens, the barn,
17 and the blacksmith’s shed are maintained as they were during Clayton’s lifetime.
18 Visitors can talk with a blacksmith as he works, and see live animals in the barn.

“The Mount Laurel Home and Estate—Part 2.” Copyright © 2022 Cognia, Inc.

21

Visitors can talk with a blacksmith as he works, and see live animals in the barn.

What change, if any, should be made to the underlined words as he works, and see live animals in line 18?

- A** as he works and see live animals
- B** as he works and, see live animals
- C** as he works and see live animals,
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

8.5.W.7: Students will use commas to separate coordinate adjectives (e.g., a fascinating, enjoyable movie).

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This is a DOK 1 because the student is recalling the rules around comma usage.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** This sentence has a compound verb and does not need a comma before the conjunction “and.”
- B.** This is a sentence with compound verbs “talk” and “see,” and the sentence does not need the comma after the conjunction “and.”
- C.** This is a sentence with compound verbs “talk” and “see,” and the sentence does not need the comma after the word “animals.”
- D.** This is a sentence with compound verbs “talk” and “see,” and the sentence does not need the comma before the conjunction “and.”